Session 13: Putting It All Together

Sales 101 (Postgraduate) | Capstone, Careers, and What Comes Next | 90 minutes

Class Agenda

Time	What we are doing
0-60	Review Simulation pre-work
52-70	Sales careers: the tracks, the money, what gets you hired
70-85	What this course did not cover, and where it lives
85-90	Closing questions

Key Objectives

#	Objective	What success looks like
LO1	Run a compressed sales cycle end to end: research, discovery, qualification, pitch.	Thirty minutes, four written outputs, all of them connected. Your pitch cites something from your own discovery.
LO3	Describe the sales career tracks and what hiring managers screen for.	You can name four roles, what each does, and the five things that get screened.
LO4	Identify what this course did not cover and where you would go for it.	You can name three areas and say which are elective material and which you would have to learn on the job.

HOW THE CAPSTONE IS SCORED

Thirty minutes. Four outputs. Written, individually, and handed in.

The rubric weights connection above quality. A brilliant pitch that does not reference your own discovery scores lower than a decent pitch that does.

This is the only assessed piece in this session. The rest is discussion.

Part 1: The Capstone

Discuss case

Part 2: Careers in Sales

The tracks

Role	What they actually do	Where it leads
SDR / BDR	Finds and qualifies new opportunities. Outreach heavy: email, LinkedIn, calls. Usually the entry point.	Account Executive
Account Executive	Owns deals end to end. Discovery, demo, negotiation, close. Carries a number.	Senior AE, Enterprise AE, Sales Manager
Customer Success Manager	Keeps customers after the sale. Renewals and expansion.	Head of Customer Success
Partnerships	Sells through other companies rather than direct.	Head of Partnerships
Sales Manager / Director	Runs a team. Coaching, forecasting, process, hiring.	VP Sales, CRO
Demand Gen / PMM	The marketing side of the same machine. Pipeline creation and positioning.	Marketing Manager, Head of Growth

Two things worth noticing. The SDR to AE to Manager path is the most common but not the only one — CS, partnerships and demand gen all branch off the same skills. And the ceiling is unusually high: CRO is one of the few functional paths to the executive team that does not require a specialist degree.

What sales leaders screen for

What they look for	What it means in an interview
Coachability	Can you take direct feedback and change behaviour by the next call? Usually tested by giving you feedback mid-interview and seeing what you do with it.
Intelligence	Can you hold a complex situation in your head and reason about it out loud?
Curiosity	Did you research this company before turning up? Do you ask questions about the business, or only about the role?
Prior success	Evidence you have been good at something competitive. It does not have to be sales.
Work ethic	Volume and consistency. In most sales roles the top performer is not doing something different, they are doing it more often.

FOUR OF THE FIVE ARE NOT ABOUT SALES

That is deliberate, and it is good news if you are not sure this is your career.

> The screening criteria are transferable and so are the skills. Research, discovery, positioning, handling objections, negotiating — these apply whether you are a founder raising money, a PM defending a roadmap, or a consultant selling a recommendation.

How to talk about this course in an interview

- Do not say you took a sales course. Say what you can do: run a discovery conversation that surfaces something the buyer did not volunteer.
- Have one specific story. The capstone today is a usable one — a case you researched, qualified and pitched in thirty minutes.
- If you are interviewing for a non-sales role, the framing is that you understand how revenue is actually made, which most candidates for that role will not.

Part 3: What This Course Did Not Cover

An honest accounting. Some of this is in the advanced elective, some of it you will learn on the job, and some of it you should go and read about yourself.

Area	What it is	Where it lives
Challenger selling and commercial insight	Teaching the buyer something about their own business that reframes what they should buy. The dominant enterprise methodology of the last decade.	Advanced B2B elective
Value selling, ROI and TCO modelling	Building the business case in numbers. What it costs to do nothing, and over what period the purchase pays back.	Advanced B2B elective
Stakeholder mapping and multi-threading	Managing six or more people across a year-long deal. Naming the coalition and working it deliberately.	Advanced B2B elective
Positioning	April Dunford's discipline. Deciding what category you are in and who you are competing against, before you write a word of messaging.	Advanced B2B elective
Revenue operations and forecasting	Pipeline coverage, conversion analytics, territory design, quota setting, commission structures.	Advanced elective, or on the job
CRM and the tool stack	Salesforce, HubSpot, outreach tooling, enrichment, data hygiene.	On the job. Learn the one your employer uses.
Proposal and document building	The actual craft of writing a proposal a committee will read.	On the job
Excel for sales	Modelling, cohort analysis, commission calculation.	Learn it yourself. It matters more than people admit.

Area	What it is	Where it lives
Storytelling	Narrative structure applied to commercial communication.	Learn it yourself. Books and practice.
Customer success as a discipline	Onboarding, adoption, renewal, expansion. A whole function this course only touched.	Principles of Modern Customer Success

THE HONEST SUMMARY OF WHAT YOU NOW HAVE

You can research an account, get a meeting, run a discovery conversation that surfaces something real, qualify against a framework, pitch to what you heard, handle an objection without folding, and negotiate on more than price.

That is a complete cycle and most people in commercial roles cannot do all of it.

What you do not yet have is depth in any one part, and reps. Both come from doing it.

Closing Questions

Five multiple-choice questions in the last five minutes.